

Aircraft noise at TW9 3PZ, Kew

SAMPLE REPORT

What the official noise map and the published flight routes say about this postcode, in Richmond upon Thames.

57 dB

average aircraft noise outdoors across a year (Lden), on DEFRA's official map. The WHO guideline is 45 dB

3.2/10

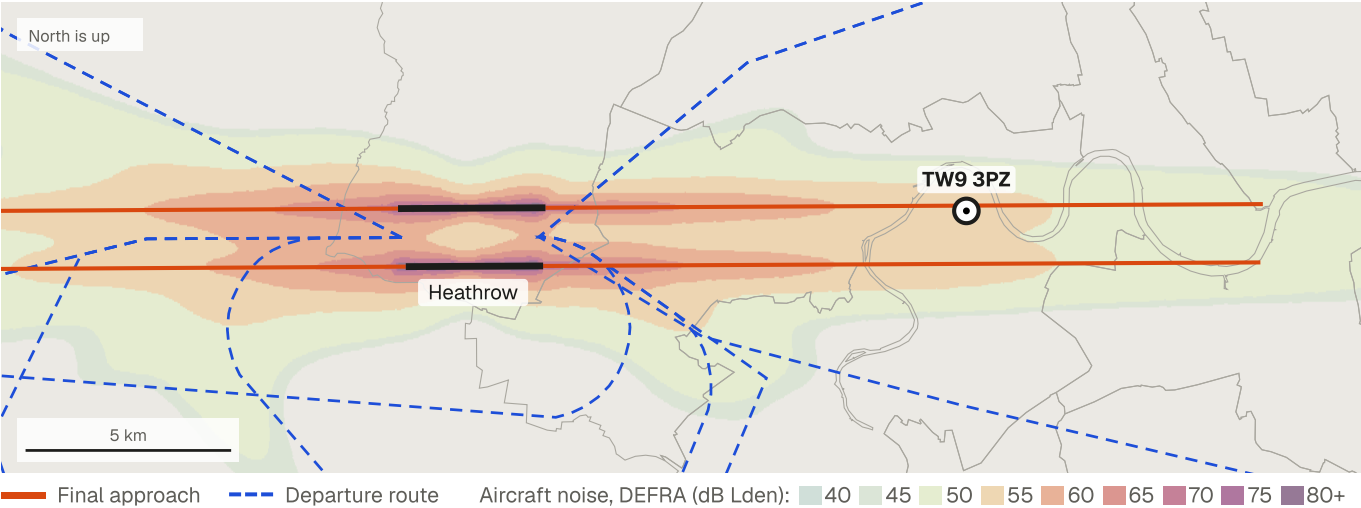
Sky Score's Quiet Skies score for this postcode. 10 is quietest

10.2 km

to the nearest runway, at Heathrow Airport, which lies to the west

0.1 km

from the approach line to Heathrow runway 27R, where landing aircraft are at about 1,800 ft



Published routes within 5 km

Route	Used when aircraft are	Closest point to this postcode	Height there
Landings, Heathrow runway 27R	landing towards the west	0.1 km to the north	about 1,800 ft
Landings, Heathrow runway 27L	landing towards the west	1.3 km to the south	about 1,800 ft
Departures, Detling route, Heathrow runway 09	taking off towards the east	4.6 km to the south	not published

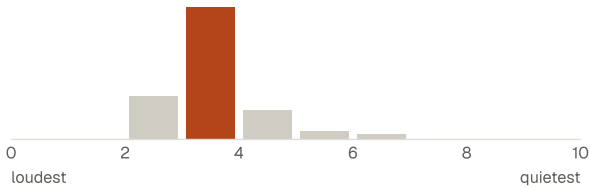
Airports covered: Heathrow and London City. Gatwick's routes are not included. Smaller airfields, military flights and helicopters are not covered.

What this shows

- Aircraft noise here averages **57 dB** outdoors across the year, 12 dB above the 45 dB the WHO recommends.
- Aircraft landing on Heathrow's runway 27R pass **0.1 km to the north** at about 1,800 ft, on days when the airport is landing towards the west.
- The nearest published departure route (Detling, runway 09) passes 4.6 km to the south.
- Of the 597 postcodes in TW9 on DEFRA's map, **61% are quieter** than this one and 29% are louder.

How it compares within TW9

Quiet Skies scores of the 597 postcodes on DEFRA's map. This postcode's band is in orange.



Also at this postcode: road noise 50.5 dB Lden (WHO guideline 53); nitrogen dioxide 17.0 µg/m³ (guideline 10); fine particles 8.6 µg/m³ (guideline 5).

Reading this report. Lden is a yearly average of the outdoor level, with evening and night flights weighted more heavily; it does not describe single loud events or the number of flights. DEFRA's map models 2021, when COVID restrictions cut air traffic. At Heathrow the CAA's model of 2024 puts the 55 dB area at 148.4 km² against 75.6 km² on DEFRA's map, so levels today are likely to be higher than DEFRA's map shows. That is an indication, not a correction. The route lines are the published centre lines: aircraft fly either side of them, and the path to joining a final approach is directed by air traffic control and is not drawn. This is information, not a survey or an environmental search; visit at different times of day before deciding.

Sources: DEFRA Strategic Noise Mapping Round 4 (aircraft and road, Lden, 2021 traffic) and DEFRA background pollution maps, Open Government Licence v3.0; flight routes from the UK Aeronautical Information Publication (NATS), AIRAC 2026-10-01; CAA ERCD Report 2501; WHO Environmental Noise Guidelines for the European Region (2018) and Global Air Quality Guidelines (2021); postcode positions from postcodes.io (ONS). Compiled with Sky Score (skyscore.co.uk). Prepared 2 October 2026.